

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 724

By Hemmer

A RESOLUTION to honor Clay Jackson upon his being conferred the Order of the Rising Sun, Gold and Silver Rays by the Consulate-General of Japan.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should recognize those individuals whose service and dedication have strengthened the cultural, civic, and international ties of the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Clay Jackson, who has devoted many years to promoting Japanese culture in Tennessee through civic leadership and community engagement; and

WHEREAS, on September 4, 2025, at a formal conferment ceremony held at the official residence of the Consul-General of Japan in Nashville, the Order of the Rising Sun, Gold and Silver Rays was conferred upon Mr. Jackson, one of Japan's highest honors bestowed upon civilians; and

WHEREAS, the Order of the Rising Sun, established in 1875, is conferred in recognition of distinguished achievements and exceptional contributions to international relations, promotion of Japanese culture, and the advancement of mutual understanding and goodwill between Japan and other nations; and

WHEREAS, Clay Jackson, together with his wife, Cathy Jackson, served with distinction as co-chairs of the Nashville Cherry Blossom Festival Advisory Committee, providing leadership and vision that helped elevate the festival into a meaningful and enduring celebration of Japanese culture and friendship; and

WHEREAS, through his long-standing involvement in the Nashville Cherry Blossom Festival, cherry tree planting initiatives throughout the Nashville area, and his support of

Cheekwood Botanical Garden, Clay Jackson has played a significant role in fostering cultural appreciation, civic pride, and environmental stewardship within this State; and

WHEREAS, beyond these efforts, Mr. Jackson has contributed substantially to the evolution of mutual understanding and friendly relations between Japan and the State of Tennessee, serving as a bridge between communities and strengthening bonds that extend beyond culture to include education, tourism, and economic cooperation; and

WHEREAS, during the conferment ceremony, Consul-General Watanabe commended Clay Jackson for his contributions to introducing Japanese culture in the United States and for his unwavering commitment to promoting friendship and mutual understanding between Japan and the United States; and

WHEREAS, the ceremony was further marked by remarks from United States Senator Bill Hagerty, who expressed gratitude for Mr. Jackson's service as a bridge between Japan and Tennessee, and from Nashville Mayor Freddie O'Connell, who highlighted the role of the Cherry Blossom Festival in strengthening cultural and economic bonds between the two communities; and

WHEREAS, through his leadership, generosity, and commitment to cultural diplomacy, Clay Jackson has brought honor to the State of Tennessee while exemplifying the values of service, cooperation, and international friendship; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Clay Jackson upon his being conferred the Order of the Rising Sun, Gold and Silver Rays by the Consulate-General of Japan, and express our sincere appreciation for his distinguished public service to his community and this State.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.